

**Honk**

Honk is a new, real-time, short-lasting messaging app aimed at Gen-Z, that features no chat history. <http://digit.in/jan21-47>

**Foldable iPhones**

Reports indicate that Apple is working on a clamshell-like foldable phone, could see the device by 2022. <http://digit.in/jan21-48>

Beyerdynamic T1 3rd generation

Democratising high-end sound

The company's new offering, the Beyerdynamic T1 3rd generation is an open-back stereo headphone that retains the design language and features of the original, critically acclaimed T1, with some slight differences. One of the main changes is that the 3rd generation model is much easier to drive for laptops and mobile devices since the new version brings the impedance down to 32ohms, in comparison to the 600ohm impedance on the old model. By doing so, the company has democratised high-end, studio-grade sound. The question is whether it still sounds open and transparent despite the lowered impedance. Let's find out.

Build and design

The Beyerdynamic T1, unlike some of Beyerdynamic's more affordable cans, is hand-assembled in the company's headquarters in Heilbronn, Germany. The luxurious nature of the headphones is apparent since the first moment you lay your hands on them. The 3rd gen model comes in a charcoal colour tone with a design language that is unmistakably Beyerdynamic - simplistic yet elegant.

Comfort and fit

The velour-covered earcups on the Beyerdynamic T1 are soft and breathable, allowing users to listen to music for hours on end without it getting too warm. Additionally, there are layers of padding, including one layer of memory foam inside the cups that make them extremely comfortable. The headband is also plush and comfortable.

Performance

As mentioned earlier, Beyerdynamic has chosen to drop down the impedance to 32ohms for the Gen 3 model from the hefty 600ohms on its predecessor. While this makes the

headphones much easier to drive without needing a dedicated amplifier, audiophiles may be left disappointed by the lack of higher impedance options. Nevertheless, Beyerdynamic claims that with its Tesla driver technology and large drivers, they are still able to deliver high fidelity reproduction from any portable player that one may use.

In our tests, we found that the new T1 has a large and open soundstage, owing to its open-back form factor, which makes tracks sound immersive and expansive. The drivers inside the cans are slightly tilted forward which increases the efficacy of spatial sound. There's plenty of width and even a fair amount of height in the sonic stage. This leads to music sounding natural and transparent. With the 3rd generation model, the T1 features a warm-leaning sonic signature with bass frequencies coming through the mix prominently. While this is uncharacteristic of open-back headphones, the bass and lows still steer clear of being muddy and don't cloud the mids. In fact, the bass frequencies have oodles of details that pushes through in tracks such as Mindstreet by Motherjane,

which has the bass guitar playing all through the track. The bass guitar sounded rich and full-bodied without hampering the quality of the vocals, which is impressive. The mids are detail-packed, however, they are slightly underextended which means that tracks feel warmer than they are meant to be, at times. Nevertheless, the detail and naturalness of the sound with the new T1 is definitely something you won't find in consumer headphones, to this degree. The highs are crisp and detailed as well, however, they aren't as sparkly as other studio-grade headphones we've reviewed such as the Meze Audio Empyrean.

Bottomline

Priced at Rs 94,599, the Beyerdynamic T1 3rd generation definitely isn't affordable. However, you pretty much get what you expect at this price point, an extraordinary build made up of premium materials and an open and transparent sonic presence. These are especially good for people who are just getting into Hi-Fi music listening, and can use a smartphone as a source. If you like a warmer sonic signature and want a pair of luxurious open-back stereo headphones, then you can definitely consider these headphones.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

TRANSDUCER: Dynamic | OPERATING PRINCIPLE: Open-back | FREQUENCY RESPONSE: 5-50,000 Hz | IMPEDANCE: 32 Ω | NOMINAL SOUND PRESSURE LEVEL: 100 dB (1 mW) | T.H.D.: <0.05% (800 Hz / 1 mW) | MAX. SOUND PRESSURE LEVEL: 124 dB (300 mW) | FORM: Over-Ear | CABLE: 3 m, double-sided | CONNECTOR: Gold-plated, three-pole stereo jack plug, 3.5 mm, and screwed adapter, 6.35 mm | WEIGHT WITHOUT CABLE: 360 g

CONTACT

BEYERDYNAMIC | PHONE: Web form | EMAIL: help@beyerdynamic.com | WEBSITE: <https://global.beyerdynamic.com/>



Price
₹94,599



BUILD AND DESIGN.....81
FEATURES.....50
PERFORMANCE.....82
VALUE.....66